
irredeemabilities

(four talismans)

for viola da gamba *and* theorbo

TRINITY HLYNN PRATER

2025 - 2026

FOREWORD

“ . . . what if we said, for example, not that it is wrong to think of so-called passive sex as ‘demeaning,’ but rather that *the value of sexuality itself is to demean the seriousness of efforts to redeem it?*” - **Leo Bersani**

“(The spirit’s) coming has no beginning, its going has no end. Thus, not a single drop of my essence remains or perishes, not a single flicker of my spirit arises or ceases. Only when there is no self, no other, no beginning, no end, can one merge with heaven and earth.” - **Yinzi**

NOTES TO THE INTERPRETERS

① GENERAL:

① ① After temporary **accidentals**, cancellation marks are printed also in the following measure (for notes in the same octave) and, in the same measure, for notes in other octaves, but they are printed again if the same note appears later in the same measure, except if the note is immediately repeated.

② ② **Quartertones** are indicated using the following accidentals:

♭ A quartertone **flat**

♯ A quartertone **sharp**

③ ③ **Dashed, hooked lines** indicate that a playing technique should be **sustained**, whereas **solid lines with arrows** indicate a **gradual transition** from one playing technique to another.

④ ④ This score follows the notational example of Luigi Nono, who used the familiar, round-arched **fermata** as an orientation point. To **triangulate** the arch indicates to **shorten** the fermata, and to **square** the arch indicates to **lengthen** the fermata. The **addition of arches** increases the relative length or shortness of the fermata. Interpreters are discouraged from developing a timing system for counting the relative length of the fermate. A fermata should be taken as an invitation to wait rather than to count, the shape of the symbol indicating the breadth of the waiting space.

② NOTE HEADS:

① ① **Finger pressure of the left hand** is indicated with **note head shapes** as follows:

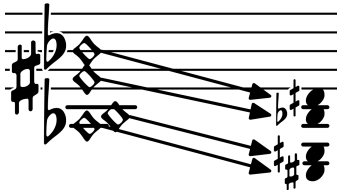
② ② **Harmonic pressure** (These note heads will be coloured in if they are attached to quarter notes. Otherwise, they are transparent.)

③ ③ **Half harmonic pressure** (half notes and larger durations)

④ ④ **Half harmonic pressure** (quarter notes and smaller durations)

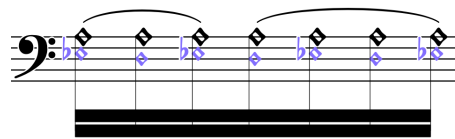
⑤ ⑤ **Percussive or unpitched actions**

⑥ ⑥ **Transitions between finger pressures** are indicated using arrows between note heads, as below:

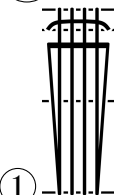


These arrows **double as glissandi** when spanning between two different pitches.

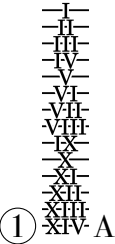
③ **Multiple muting** of the string is accomplished by **fingering two or more places on the same string at once**. This is indicated with **small, blue note heads** beneath the upper node, as below:



III STAVES AND CLEFS:



① A **four-line staff** wherein the top line indicates to play **behind the bridge**, the next to play **on the bridge**, the next to play at the **center of the fingerboard**, and the next to play at the **bottom of the fingerboard**, near the nut.



① A **seven-line staff** (for viola da gamba) or a **fourteen-line staff** (for theorbo) wherein the **top line** indicates to play on **string I**, the **next line** on **string II**, and so on.

IV ABBREVIATIONS:

- ① **dp.** = Dietro ponticello (play on the strings behind the bridge)
- ② **ob.** = On the bridge (play directly on the bridge)
- ③ **xp.** = Extreme sul ponticello (play with half of the right hand implement directly on the bridge, and the other half on the string)
- ④ **msp.** = Molto sul ponticello (play very close to the bridge)
- ⑤ **p.** = Sul ponticello (play near the bridge)
- ⑥ **ord.** = Ordinario (cancels right hand contact point instructions)
- ⑦ **t.** = Sul tastò (play near the fingerboard)
- ⑦ **mst.** = Molto sul tastò (play above the edge of the fingerboard)
- ⑧ **xt.** = Extreme sul tastò (play with the right hand as close to the left hand as possible)
- ⑨ **rasg.** = Rasgueado
- ⑩ **Scratch** = Scratch tone (play with enough right hand pressure to remove as much pitch from the sound as possible)
- ⑪ **Norm.** = Normale (cancels right hand pressure instructions)
- ⑫ **CLT** = Col legno tratto
- ⑬ **CLB** = Col legno battuto
- ⑭ **LH/RH** = Right hand/Left hand

Ⓥ VIOLA DA GAMBA:

① Two **finger-pressure trills** appear in the piece. They are:

- | ◊~~~~~ between open string and harmonic pressure, and
- | ×~~~~~ between open string and percussive pressure.

②

▤→ Indicates to draw the bow evenly from **au talon** to **punta d’arco** over the duration of the articulated note.

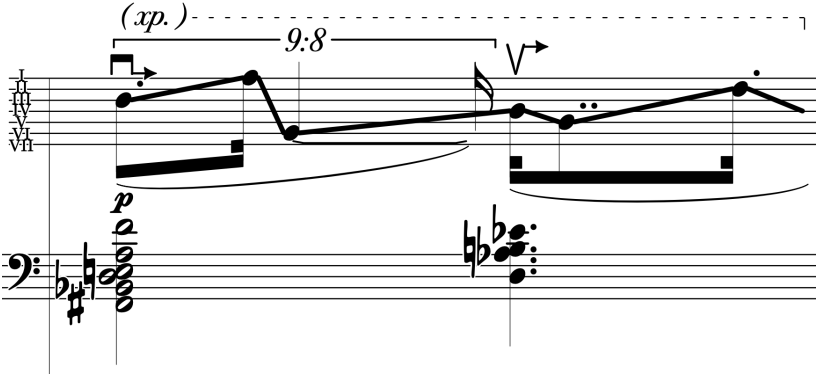
▥→

Indicates to draw the bow evenly from **punta d’arco** to **au talon** over the duration of the articulated note.

③

⊕ Indicates to **damp** the string with the **left hand**, removing as much pitch as possible.

④ Throughout the piece, a kind of **bariolage** appears, wherein the left hand maintains a **single chord** while the bow moves irregularly across the affected strings. For example,

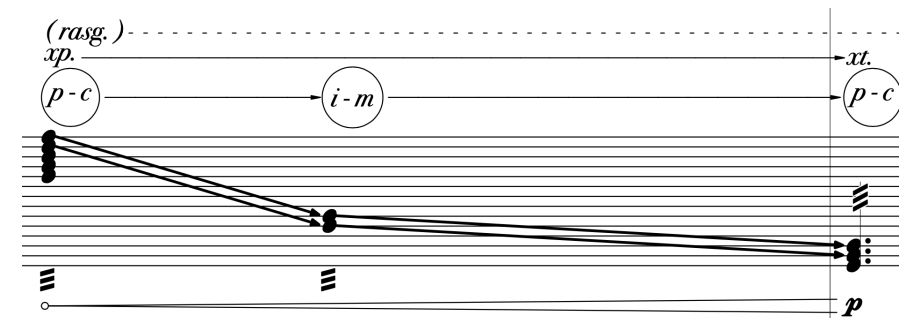


in the above excerpt, the right hand should draw the bow across the strings indicated by the top staff. The lines in between discreet arrival points should blur across all affected strings in the range, though still moving in a clear trajectory from one notated string to the next.

Ⓥ THEORBO:

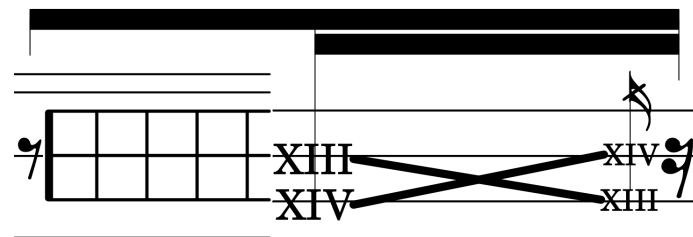
① The interpreter should be equipped with a **plectrum**.

② Throughout the piece, a **rasgueado** is used wherein the amount of finger used, position on the string, and strings affected are specified. For example,

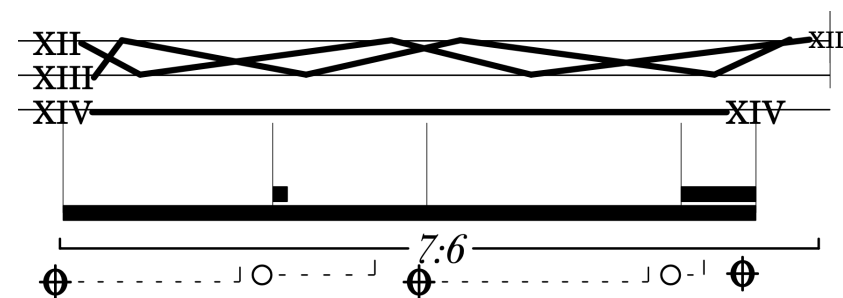


in the above excerpt, the right hand should transition from using all fingers, to using only the index through middle fingers, and back all fingers, while moving the hand from extreme sul ponticello to extreme sul tasto. At the same time, the right hand should gradually change from affecting strings I-V, to strings IX-X, to strings XII-XIV.

③ In the excerpt below,



the left hand should gradually pull strings XIII and XIV across one another in order to mute them and create a snare-like muting. At other points in the piece, as below:



the same technique is performed on strings XII and XIII while a third finger only mutes and unmutes string XIV according to the rhythm below the staff. These excerpts are only from the left hand staff, as the techniques they use are always paired with some instruction in the right hand, usually a rasgueado.

to Athena Zenker Díaz and Mauricio Galeano

irredeemabilities

(four talismans)

Trinity Hlynn Prater (*2000)

3/4 = 48

3/7

3/4

Viola da Gamba

IV
scr. ———→ norm.
t. ———→

Theorbo

pp
(LH finger percussion on accents) ·

p ———→ *xp*
(rasg.) ———→
(p-c) ———→ (i-a)

p ———→

(touching all strings affected by RH) ———→

3:2

5:6

9:8

norm. —→ fl. —→ 1/2 scr. —→ norm. —→ 2/3 scr. —→ norm.
xp. —→ mst. —→ p. —→ ob.
(LH finger percussion on accents) ·

3:2

3:2

p

7:8

fff

XIII
XIV

3
7
3
4
3
7

norm. ———→ *scr.*
ob. ———→ *dp.*

(*rasg.*)
p. ———→ *xt.*
i - m ———→ *p - c*
7:6

scr.
dp.

tailpiece

“ff” ———→ *7:8* *mp* ———→ *p* ———→ *3:2*

(*rasg.*)
xp.
p - c ———→ *i - m* ———→ *xt.*
p - c

(*touching all strings affected by RH*)

V ———→ VI ———→ VII ———→
norm. ———→ *1/2 scr.*

xt.
p - c

7:6

viol. ④

p ———→ *mp* ———→ *p*

thb.

pp < *mp* < *pp* ———→ *mp* > *pp* < *p*

XII
XIII
XIV

“ff” ———→ *7:8* *mp* ———→ *p* ———→ *3:2*

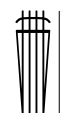
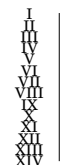
p

XII
XIII
XIV

p

XII
XIII
XIV

7:6



3
7

3
4

8

viol.

tailpiece

7:8

3:2

“ff”

mp

p

(rasg.)

xp.

p-c

i-m

thb.

(touching all strings affected by RH)

scr.

dp.

IV

msp.

V

VI

norm.

VII

1/2 scr.

t.

xl.

p-c

p

XII

XIII

XIV

XIV

7:6



X

X

11

24"

viol.

thb.

IV

pp

X

X

12

13"

viol.

thb.

7 32

7 32

3 16

3 16

3 5

3 5

6 8

6 8

7 32 = 63

3 16 = 112

ob. w/ plectrum

ppp

mp

mf

13:14

4:3

7:8

15:16

5:6

9:12

7 16

4 16

6 32

3 8

17

viol.

thb.

17:14

5:4

5:6

11:12

mf

pmp

f

p

fmp

pp

mfmp

8/4 7/16 = 84 4/8 7/32

21

viol.

(ob.)

thb.

p *7:8* *mp* *5:4* *pp* *mf* *p* *mf* *f*

msp. *p.*

f

5:4

6/4 3/8 3/16

25

viol.

ord. IV

VII

V

VI

III

IV

II

I

mf *p* *mp* *f* *p* *f* *mp* *pp* *mf* *mp* *p* *mf* *pp* *mf* *p* *mf*

legatissimo sempre

xp. *p.*

thb.

p *f* *mp* *pp*

6
4

♩ = 63

7
8

(28)

$\frac{7}{16}$ ♩ = 112

$\frac{2}{8}$

$\frac{6}{32}$

$\frac{3}{8}$

$\frac{8}{4}$ ♩ = 48

Violin (viol.)

Measure 33: *ppp* to *p* (trill), *xp.* (V), *p.* (trill), *tr* (trill).
 Measure 34: *tr* (trill).
 Measure 35: *f* (finger perc.), *f*.
 Measure 36: *p* (V), *p.* (trill).
 Measure 37: *ppp* (V), *xp.* (trill).

Theremin (thb.)

Measure 33: *p* (III msp. (still w/ plectrum) trill).
 Measure 34: *f* (H), *mp* (H), *ob.* 1.
 Measure 35: *f* (H), *f*.
 Measure 36: *ppp* (H), *7:6*, *3:2*.
 Measure 37: *ppp* (H), *6:7*, *3:2*, *6:7*, *7:8*, *3:2*.

Violoncello (Vc)

Measure 37: *ppp* (trill), *xp.* (trill).

$\frac{7}{16} \text{ } \text{♩} = 112$

$\frac{4}{8}$

$\frac{7}{32}$

$\frac{6}{4} \text{ } \text{♩} = 48$

Violin (viol.)

38

finger perc.

f

p

pp

(rasg.)

p.

(w/o plectrum)

i - m

xt.

p - c

6:7

6:7

Theremin (thb.)

pp

mp

pp

mp

pp

p

6:7

6:7

ob. w/ plectrum -

6:7

ob.

7:6

ob.

7:6

ob.

XII

XIII

XIV

f

p

f

p

f

p

f

3/8 = 112 3/16 6/4 = 48

42

viol.

(xp.) → *t.*

p

(rasg. w/o plectrum)

msp. → *t.*

p - c → *m - c*

thb.

mp → *pp*

(touching all strings affected by RH)

(w/ plectrum) xp

f

finger perc.

7:6

arco (bowing close to LH as possible)

7:8

7:8

mp

ord.

p

=

7/8 *accel. (to ♩ = 84)* 2/8 = 84 3/4

45

viol.

mst.

norm.

dp.

scratch

tailpiece

p

3:2

ff

t.

3:2

7:8

thb.

mp

7/8 4/8 3/16 7/32

48

scratch
dp.

tailpiece

viol.

p 6:7 "ff"

t. 6:7

7:8

thb.

mp

mp

||

4/8 3/8 ♩ = 63 6/4 6/8

52

scratch
dp.

tailpiece

viol.

p 3:2 "ff"

7:8

t. 3:2

7:8

thb.

mp

p

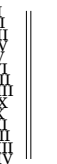
(rasg.)
xt.

(w/o plectrum)

i - m *i - a* *i - c* *p - c*

XIII XIV

XIII XIV



6/8 $\text{♩} = 112$

57

viol.

mf *p* 7:6 *mp* 4:3 *f*

(*rasg.*)
i-c

t. *xp.* *t.* *mst.* *xp.* *p* *xt.* *ord.* *t.*

thb.

mf *p* *mp* *f* *p*

7:6 4:3

60

viol.

xp. *p* *xt.* *ord.*

p *f* *mp*

7:6

thb.

xp. *t.* *mst.* *xp.* *p* *xt.* *ord.* *t.* *xp.* *t.*

7:6 *f* *mp* *pp* *mf*

7

♩ = 84

16

64

ord.

xp.

viol.

pp

mf

mp

p

mp

pp

mf

(rasg.)

i-c

xp.

xt.

thb.

mp

p

mp

pp

mf

p

5:6

7:8

5:4

3:2

2

♩ = 63

8

71

“fff” Solo

Con fuoco

Con licenza

viol.

3:2

5:4

9:8

5:4

thb.

On-the-string,
full bows as possible
but with strong rearticulations.

3

16

78

Grip both sides of the bow
firmly with each hand,
using as much pressure as possible, 1/2 CLT.

3

8

♩ = 48

viol.

thb.

sim. (like mm. 78)



88

sim.

viol.

thb.



8

4

92

viol.

thb.

mf

pp

94

viol.

thb.

7/8 *accel. (to ♩ = 84)*

32 ♩ = 84

crossing strings over each other with LH, sempre

fff

Viol. 1/2 CLB, striking all strings as hard as possible, sempre

97

fff

3
16

7:9

thb.

Violin (viol.) and Trombone (thb.) score, measures 109-116. The score is in 3/4 time. The Violin part features a melodic line with many triplets and a 7:6 ratio indicated. The Trombone part has a lower melodic line with triplets and a 7:6 ratio indicated. The score includes a key signature of one flat and a common time signature.

114

viol.

thb.

7:6

xt.

p-c

f

XIII

XIV

116

37♩ = 60
16

viol.

p
(*rasg.*)
xt.
p-c

thb.

f

XII
XIII
XIV
○

=

117

viol.

dp.
⊕

ord.

thb.

mp >

118

tailpiece

viol.

“fff”

xp.

i - m

thb.

pp

XIII

XIV

AFTERWORD

“Yet love exists without consciousness, like interlocking chains; vision exists without consciousness, like a lamp’s illumination.”

- **Yinzi**